FOR FOUNDERS ABOUT TO CLOSE A ROUND

Interview your investor before you cash the check.

Five questions to ask first.



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I coach founders.

1

First, ask about their worst month.

Anyone is helpful when the numbers are up. Ask for a time they were not.



Ask for one portfolio company that struggled

Listen for what they did, not how they describe it.

Then call that founder yourself

One short call tells you more than a polished intro.

References beat reputation

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2

Second, ask what they do in the next round.

This check is not your last one. Ask how they treat the next.

↳ **Do they reserve money to follow on?**

A plain yes or no. Ask roughly how much.



↳ **What happens if you need a bridge?**

Their answer shows how they act when it is hard.

↳ **A vague answer now is still an answer**

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3

Third, ask for one real intro.

Help is easy to promise and hard to measure. Make it specific.



Which intro did you make last quarter?

Ask who it was, and what came of it.

What will you do for us first?

A plan with a name in it beats a general offer.

Specific help is real help

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THE TELL

How they react is part of the answer.

A good investor welcomes these questions. Hesitation is information.



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Fourth, ask who decides and how fast.

A yes from one partner is not yet a wire.



Who else has to approve this check?

A partner, a committee, a co-investor.

What has to happen before the wire?

Ask for the steps and the dates, in order.

No surprises after the handshake

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Finally, ask what win they need.

Investors run on fund timelines. Yours may not match.

What size outcome makes this check worthwhile?

A fund needs big wins. Check your plan can offer one.



How long are they willing to wait?

Their timeline should fit yours before you sign.

Mismatched timelines end in friction

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Ask all five before you sign.

Out loud, in the room, before the wire.

↳ **Repost for a founder about to take a first check**



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